

Hackathon 2025

18 – 22 August 2025

“Innovating for an Inclusive and Resilient Future”

This year’s hackathon theme calls on students to think boldly and systemically not just about technology, but about transforming society, communities, and industries through interdisciplinary collaboration.

The theme is directly inspired by the G20 2025 priorities, including sustainable development, ethical technology, inclusive economic growth, and future skills. It aligns strongly with the curricula of Richfield and AAA including Information Technology, Business, Public Management, Marketing, and Creative Brand Communication.

Students are expected to:

- Identify a real-world problem aligned to one of the focus areas.
- Develop a solution (technical, strategic, or creative) that is inclusive in its impact and sustainable over time.
- Demonstrate interdisciplinary collaboration by forming teams that span diverse strengths across IT, Business, Public Management, Marketing, Design, and Creative Communication.

Teams must reflect the reality of the modern world of work, demonstrating the ability to collaborate across qualifications, disciplines, and perspectives. Richfield and AAA students are encouraged to form integrated teams where developers, analysts, brand strategists, creatives, and communicators work together showcasing not only their individual expertise, but also their capacity to engage diverse viewpoints, manage complexity, and co-create impactful solutions.

Focus Areas to Guide Student Teams *(not limited to the below)*

In order to focus student ideation, the following broad challenge areas are proposed. These reflect real-world urgency and curricula relevance. Please do not be limited by these topics:

- Digital Transformation for Inclusive Growth e.g., tech solutions for access to healthcare, education, or small business support
- AI, Emerging Technologies & Creative Public Good e.g., AI for public health, robotics for environmental monitoring, or accessible data tools
- Cybersecurity and Digital Trust e.g., campaigns or tools to build online safety, privacy, and ethical digital spaces
- Financial and Social Inclusion e.g., fintech solutions for the informal sector or platforms that demystify financial systems
- Climate Action & Sustainable Innovation e.g., apps or campaigns that promote climate awareness, green tech, or carbon tracking
- Future of Work & Employment e.g., digital upskilling platforms, gig economy tools, or mentorship ecosystems
- Empowering SMMEs e.g., tools, campaigns, or platforms that support local entrepreneurs and small businesses
- Inclusive Storytelling & Creative Activism e.g., campaigns that advocate for diversity, equity, and social justice

Evaluation Rubric

This rubric is to be used during the campus-level evaluations to assess student team presentations and solution showcases. The criteria reflect the interdisciplinary, impact-driven, and innovation-oriented spirit of the Hackathon.

Evaluation Criteria	Description	Weight
Relevance to Theme	How well does the solution reflect the theme of inclusivity, innovation, and resilience? Does it address a real-world problem aligned to the proposed focus areas?	20%
Innovation and Originality	Does the project introduce a novel idea, new application, or unique approach? Is there evidence of creative problem-solving?	20%

Feasibility and Potential Impact	Is the solution practical and implementable? Does it have potential for meaningful social, economic, or environmental impact?	20%
Interdisciplinary Collaboration	Does the team reflect diversity across disciplines (IT, Business, Creative, etc.)? Is there evidence of integrated thinking and teamwork?	15%
Presentation Quality & Communication	Was the pitch clear, well-structured, and engaging? Did the team communicate their ideas effectively to the audience/judges?	15%
Technical or Creative Execution	How well was the solution built, visualised, or demonstrated? Does it reflect depth in either technical or creative execution?	10%
Total		100%